

VPN Failure After Client Update

Service Desk Runbook | Category: VPN | Test document

Purpose and problem

Use this procedure when a user cannot connect to the corporate VPN after an approved VPN client software update. This procedure is for post-update connection failures, including a client stuck at Connecting or a connection timeout. It is not the password-reset or invalid-credentials procedure.

Confirm the symptom

Ask when the client was updated and record the displayed error and approximate time. Confirm the device can reach an ordinary public website. If the user is on guest, hotel, or airport Wi-Fi, have them complete that network's sign-in page in a browser before retrying the VPN.

Refresh the approved client session

1. Disconnect the VPN session.
2. Fully quit the approved VPN client, including its notification-area or system-tray process if present.
3. Reopen the client and select the organization-managed VPN connection profile.
4. If the client reports that its profile is outdated, refresh the profile only through the organization's approved device-management process. Do not use an unverified gateway, remove certificates, or disable security controls.

VPN Failure After Client Update (continued)

Authenticate safely

Sign in through the organization's normal authentication flow. Approve a multi-factor prompt only when the user initiated the sign-in and the prompt matches it. Never ask the user to disclose a password, one-time code, token, or recovery key.

Escalate if unresolved

If the connection still fails after reopening the client and selecting the managed profile, record the VPN client version, operating system, exact error text, update time, and whether other users are affected. Attach an approved diagnostic bundle if policy allows, then route the incident to Network Support. Do not apply the password-reset troubleshooting procedure unless the incident independently reports an authentication failure after a password change.

Success criteria

Ask the user to confirm that the VPN connects and that an approved internal resource is reachable. Document which steps were completed and their outcomes in the incident work notes. This sample runbook contains no real account details, credentials, or production VPN address.